# Dr Stephen deWit

# Lead Human

Leading with Relational Intelligence When Pressure Is High and Change Is Constant



## Biography

Dr. Stephen de Wit is a globally sought-after human connection expert who helps leaders unlock performance, retention, and trust by mastering relational intelligence. Drawing on 20+ years across private practice, retreats, and research with vulnerable populations, his Lead Human™ framework shows leaders how to eliminate silent friction and build cultures where people thrive.

- 170 Keynotes delivered
- 7,000+ Leaders Ready for What's Next
- Where insight turns into change

## Trusted By Leaders At

DOCLER HOLDING · MDRT · primed · CAO ACO · CAHSPR ACRSPS · ruby · reckitt · NESO Northeastern Society of Orthodontists · Lakeridge Health

## Why Work With Stephen

- Deep, Human-Centered Thought Leadership
- Proven Impact in High-Stakes Environments
- Uncommon Background, Powerful Lens
- Authentic, Engaging, and Memorable On Stage
- Professional, Seamless Client Experience

## Who Stephen Serves

- Executive Teams & Senior Leaders
- Managers & Emerging Leaders
- Teams Navigating Change, Growth, or Cultural Strain
- Associations & Professional Membership Organizations
- Human-Centered Organizations

## What Stephen Solves

- Silent friction eroding trust and performance
- Leadership breakdowns rooted in disconnection
- Talent loss from relational breakdowns
- Burnout caused by low psychological safety
- Misalignment and tension across teams

## Signature Keynote

### LEAD HUMAN: RELATIONAL INTELLIGENCE AT WORK BUILDING TRUST, PERFORMANCE & RETENTION

Unlock sustainable performance by mastering the human dynamics that drive trust, engagement, and loyalty—especially when pressure is high and connection is strained.



## Signature Keynote

# Lead Human™: The Human Edge

## How Relational Intelligence Fuels Performance, Retention & Trust

### Overview

In high-pressure, often hybrid workplaces, performance breakdowns are rarely technical, they are relational.

Burnout, disengagement, retention loss, and cultural drift are symptoms of a deeper issue: leaders have been trained to manage tasks, not human systems.

This keynote introduces a practical, research-informed framework for eliminating silent friction, strengthening trust, and leading with influence rather than control.

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### Audience Outcomes

Participants will:

- Diagnose the hidden relational dynamics that impact retention and engagement
- Apply a clear framework for high-trust leadership
- Reduce tension and misalignment before performance declines
- Rebuild trust quickly after breakdowns
- Lead with presence and emotional credibility under pressure

Leaders leave with a repeatable relational strategy they can implement immediately.

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Let's connect! ➡ 647.483.4490 ➡

# Additional Topics

## Invisible Friction

**Why Teams Break Down — and How to Eliminate the Hidden Barriers to Performance**

- Identify silent breakdowns affecting culture and collaboration
- Surface difficult conversations productively
- Replace avoidance with alignment
- Embed accountability without eroding trust

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## The Hidden Multiplier

**How Relational Intelligence Drives Retention, Safety & Results**

- Connect relational patterns to measurable performance outcomes
- Reduce turnover through trust-centered leadership
- Increase engagement through daily relational rituals
- Protect culture during growth and change

# SPEAKER BIO

Use the version below that best serves your audience. If you need a custom tweak, a fresh angle, or something built specifically for your event theme, just let us know at info@drdewit.com or 647.483.4490 — we're happy to tailor it.

**ONE SENTENCE BIO** *(~26 words)*

Maybe it's years spent in rooms where silence spoke louder than titles, but Dr. Stephen de Wit helps leaders turn human tension into high-trust cultures people fight to stay in.

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**TWO SENTENCE BIO***(~67 words)*

Dr. Stephen de Wit didn't learn leadership in a boardroom—he learned it in rooms where the Wi-Fi was optional, but trust was everything. After two decades in private practice, transformational retreats, and research with homeless veterans and people living with dementia, he now helps leaders harness real human dynamics and turn them into practical strategies that strengthen trust, retention, and performance under pressure.

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**A FEW SENTENCES BIO***(~114 words)*

Dr. Stephen de Wit didn't climb the corporate ladder—he built his expertise in rooms where trust was fragile, and conversations actually mattered. For more than 20 years, his work has lived at the frontlines of vulnerability, conflict, and connection, from private practice and transformational retreats to research with homeless veterans and individuals living with dementia. Along the way, Stephen uncovered what most leadership playbooks quietly miss: when people don't feel seen, safe, or heard, performance doesn't explode—it erodes. Today, he brings those battle-tested insights to the stage, equipping leaders to eliminate silent friction, rebuild trust quickly, and create cultures where people don't just perform under pressure—they lean in, step up, and stay.

# 🎤 Audio, Visual & Logistical Requirements

*(So we can create something unforgettable together.)*

Here's what we need to make sure the message lands, the room feels electric, and no one squints at a slide.

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## 🎧 AUDIO

*(Because if they can't hear it, they can't feel it.)*

- A **wireless headset microphone** (preferred — Stephen moves and engages the room)
  *A wireless lavalier is acceptable if needed.*
- Professional sound system appropriate for room size
- Fresh batteries (we like energy on stage, not surprises)

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## 🎥 VISUAL

*(Let's make sure the message lands in every seat.)*

- Projection system and screen(s) visible to the full audience
- Projector with HDMI input and cable (if using Stephen's laptop)
- Confidence monitors at the foot of the stage (at least one)
  *This keeps flow strong and eye contact where it belongs — on your audience.*
- Countdown timer visible from stage
  *So we finish strong and on time.*

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## 🎚️ SOUNDCHECK

*(Where the magic gets calibrated.)*

- A minimum 30-minute soundcheck
- In the presentation room
- Completed before doors open and guests enter
- On the day of delivery

This ensures everything runs smoothly and Stephen can focus fully on delivering impact.
Thanks so much for your partnership.

Let's connect! ➡ 647.483.4490 ➡

Below is Stephen's introduction. Please read it to welcome him to the stage — your energy helps set the moment. Thank you!

Most leadership experts study performance from books and spreadsheets.

Dr. Stephen de Wit studied it in the raw, real moments where relationships either break down... or break through.

For more than twenty years, he's worked at the frontlines of human connection — as a therapist, sexologist, researcher, speaker and facilitator of transformational experiences. He's sat in rooms where trust was fragile, silence was loud, and the cost of disconnection was very real.

What he discovered?
When people don't feel seen, safe, or understood, performance doesn't accelerate... it quietly erodes.

Today, he brings that uncommon lens to share with us.

Blending behavioral science with lived human insight, Stephen helps leaders eliminate invisible friction, rebuild trust fast, and create cultures where people don't just perform... they lean in.

Please welcome the voice behind the *Lead Human* movement... Dr. Stephen de Wit.